

Setting up

Download the latest stable version of WriteMonkey for from <http://writemonkey.com/download.php#latest>. It's portable and needs no installation; just extract and double click on the 'm' icon in the WriteMonkey folder that is created to start writing.



Better than Dark Room or LightRoom for Mac

Using the keyboard

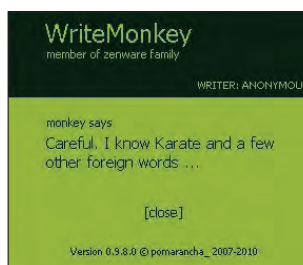
Most apps give you tips on start up. WriteMonkey does it differently by displaying a little green window with the heading 'monkey says' and a some part-clever, part-funny quote you'd typically see on t-shirts.

If you find this irritating, you can go to **Edit > Preferences** (or press [F10]) and uncheck the box which says 'Show 'Monkey says' at launch' – but we suspect the quotes will keep you hooked – and click on OK. The next time you access WriteMonkey, you'll go straight to the text editor.

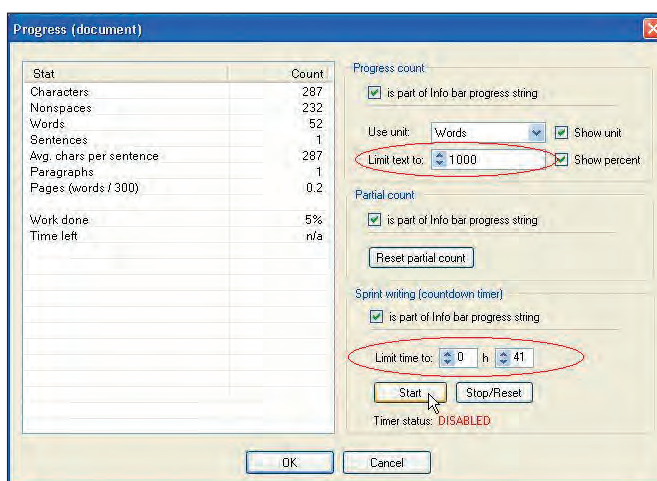
Progress report

Another terrific thing about this text editor is that it gives you live statistics about the text you've been typing. After you've typed for a bit, just hit [F12] or go to

View > Progress from the drop down menu above. WriteMonkey gives you an easily understandable list of statistics ranging from the number of words, characters and paragraphs you've typed to the average number of letters you type per sentence. It gets even better when you find you can set time limits and word limits for each document. If you're sure there should be a fixed number of words in the document (every journalist's constraint), simply click in the 'Limit text to' tab and fill in the word limit. You could even restrict the time taken to type the document by enabling the stop watch facility. Click on the 'Start' button above the line of text which says **Timer status: DISABLED** after you've filled in the time limit in the tabs above it. Instantly, the Dis-



Quips instead of tips



Press F1 for instant assistance

abled status will turn to **RUNNING** which means the timer has begun the countdown. Don't forget to click on OK to save your settings.

Lookups

The Lookup feature lets you check up the meaning, synonyms and pronunciation of a word directly from WriteMonkey. Simply select a word and right-click on it to open the really long list of options in the context menu. Click on 'Lookups' and choose the site you want infor-

mation from. WriteMonkey gives you direct access to key sites like Wikipedia, Answers.com, Reference.com, and Thesaurus.com among others. You can even skip the mouse entirely. Just select the

word and use shortcuts for direct access to these sites through your default internet browser ([Alt]+[1] for

Answers.com and [Alt]+[2] for Reference.com). You could also go to **View > Lookups** for the same purpose.

Changing colours

Over a period of time the monochrome look of WriteMonkey may get tedious. A great feature that can assist you here is the

Set progress controls

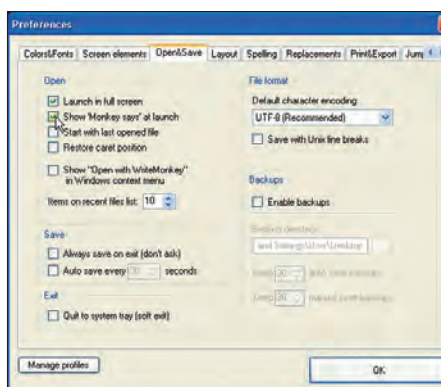
'Generate new random colors' option. Simply press [Alt]+[L] and watch the screen change into different background and font colour combinations.

Jumps

WriteMonkey lets you jump straight to headings or paragraphs of your choice with the cool 'Jump' feature. You can toggle this feature on or off with the shortcut [Alt]+[J] or go to **View > Jumps** from the menu above. Like the sidebar in MS Office 2010, once you click on a particular heading or paragraph, it's immediately selected in the document for you to edit.

Export snippets

You can even export small portions of text as separate text files into MS Word or your web browser. Simply



Get rid of the smart one-liners